Anna M. Campbell

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Prototyping and Storytelling Where Art Meets Science

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Millions of views | 3,000-visitor exhibit | 500-attendee summit | Cost per lead halved | Angel's Choice Award

SUMMARY

Founder of an independent science communication studio and a creative producer who uses curiosity and humor to make research feel human through toys, tools, and stories. **12+** years leading storytelling for research, technology, and mission-driven organizations, taking ideas from concept to working prototype to a demo, film, or room people can walk into. Produced *The Swim* (Shorty Award nominee) with Discovery and **27 research institutions** and Reinvent 2025, a 500-attendee summit delivered under budget, and built *Turning the Tide*, an immersive ocean exhibit on Governors Island. Builds working AI prototypes daily, from Whisper voice apps and AI-designed live games to a moderator model's safety rules. Biologist by training, M.A. in Media Innovation.

SKILLS AND TOOLS

Expertise: Concept development · Interactive prototyping · Interface, interaction, and visual design · Generative media · Research demos · Case study development · Creative direction · Experience design · Experimentation with AI models · Cross-disciplinary collaboration · Film and video · Content strategy · Audience testing

Making and production: Unity · Vuforia · Blender · Sketchfab · Arduino · 3D printing · Laser cutting · Adobe Creative Suite (incl. Premiere) · CapCut · Descript · Figma · Canva · Flourish · Datawrapper · HTML/CSS · YouTube Studio

AI, LLMs, analytics, and emerging tools: OpenAI (ChatGPT, Whisper, image generation) · Claude (Claude Code, agents) · Lovable · Gemini · ElevenLabs · NotebookLM · Zapier · Airtable · Google Analytics

EXPERIENCE

Founder and Creative Director | Solarpunk Studio, Northern CA (remote) 2021 – Present

Built and lead an independent science communication studio for energy, technology, and research organizations, best known for case studies that document how the work was made and why it matters; hire and direct contractors in design, video, and voice.

Select client engagements

- **WATT Coalition (grid modernization):** Run the editorial calendar and quarterly newsletter for **750** utility and policy leaders (3+ years); codified grid-technology messaging into a voice and tone guide that governs all WATT content. LinkedIn engagement runs **40%** above the B2B median; produced explainer videos and innovator case studies.
- **ORBTL.AI (geospatial startup):** Led go-to-market for its rebrand and online launch, adapting academic material into how-to guides that drew new government and NGO interest.
- **The Nature Conservancy, Innovation Division:** Produced a case study video series on its innovation process, with animated design-thinking sequences on faster conservation; now part of employee onboarding.
- **California Marine Sanctuary Foundation:** Built the brand architecture, messaging framework, and phased launch strategy that positioned it to scale proven marine conservation protocols nationally.
- **Braided River Books:** Built an interactive digital portal for *Living River*, a National Outdoor Book Award winner, where readers travel down the Colorado River watershed and meet the people interviewed; visualized the crisis for its campaign and traveling exhibit, helping drive **10M+** impressions.
- **Converge Strategies (energy security consultancy):** Built its go-to-market messaging and comms roadmap and helped launch a thought-leadership podcast.
- **Arctic Tern Expeditions:** Led climate storytelling and partnerships that **fully booked** its 2024 High Arctic season.
- **Ocean Youth Academy:** Localized its flagship Arctic science course for students in Kenya, re-shooting ten modules for three grade levels and building the LMS; it now anchors a pending **$200K** edtech deal.

Studio platform and programs

- **Run every part of the business**, from P&L, pricing, and sales to contracts and compliance, and treat each project as an ROI decision, testing offers with paid ads (**halved cost per lead** year over year).
- **Launched and run** *Visible Brilliance*, a cohort program for women in STEM, and designed its 8-week *Field Season* curriculum of **eight original games**, using AI to build game structures and assets, with Field Days judged by experts.
- **Developed and built** *Turning the Tide*, a sponsored immersive ocean exhibit on Governors Island (3,000+ visitors), using AI from pitch to install for concept art, iPad apps from partner data, review portals, layout, and materials.

Project Manager | Reinventing Media, Northeastern University, Boston, MA (remote) 2020 – Present

Foundation-funded academic-industry initiative on the future of news media; promoted from graduate researcher. Also Research Assistant, Northeastern Immersive Media Lab (2020–2021).

- **Manage a Stanton Foundation–funded partnership** (current phase: **$3M**) linking Northeastern faculty, Harvard Kennedy School's Shorenstein Center (which published our research), and **six newsrooms** across three phases, whose fellows won an Edward R. Murrow Award; coordinate research, fellowships, curriculum, and publicity.
- **Led AI workshops** for journalists and ran experiments and surveys on bringing AI into newsrooms safely, including prototypes built with Northeastern engineering students.
- **Lead a core team of 10–14** (faculty, journalist fellows, students, and a research firm); run all digital communications.
- **Designed original research** on how animation and information design make complex information more memorable; designed the playbook *Reinvent: A Survival Guide for Local TV News* and helped land *WSJ* and TheWrap coverage.
- **Produced "Reinvent 2025,"** a two-day summit with 3 keynotes, 14 panels, and **47 presenters**, including Vox Media Editor-in-Chief Swati Sharma, PBS Digital Studios head Maribel Lopez, and The Washington Post's TikTok team, and **nearly 500 attendees** from GBH, The Boston Globe, NBCUniversal, and more; delivered under its **$71K** budget.
- **Designed and built the** *Data Playground*, a room that turned our research data into hands-on displays with VR storytelling demos, using AI to estimate and spec materials; built the NAB Show booth.

Producer, Original Programming | Seeker (Discovery Digital / Group Nine), San Francisco, CA 2017 – 2020

Grew to **3 million subscribers** during my tenure; billed as "the most engaged science brand on social."

- **Pitched, wrote, and produced six science series** (*Elements*, *Sick*, *Science in the Extremes*, *Tusks to Tails*, *The Swim*, *How Close Are We?*), from synthetic life to AI agents and quantum computing, shaping each format and look.
- **Led editors, cinematographers, and motion designers** on studio, field, and remote shoots, on budget and deadline.
- **Partnered with scientists at NASA, MIT, Harvard, NIH**, and others to turn their findings into scripts and storyboards.
- **Owned thumbnails, titles, and metadata**, swapping packaging on performance; *How Close Are We?* drew 21M+ views across 28 episodes.
- Prototyped a new format for 360 video: developed VR pilot episodes on the physics of extreme sports, invented a storyboarding method for 360 content, wrote scripts, and set up the shoots.
- **Designed and built Seeker's event displays** from scratch, including *The Swim* installations at Bay Area Science Festival and the Omnicom advertising summit (NYC) and a California Academy of Sciences NightLife display.

> **The Swim** *(Seeker × Discovery) | Project Manager and YouTube Producer | 2018*
> Coordinated *The Swim*, a multiplatform science "brand stunt" built with Discovery, endurance athlete Ben Lecomte, citizen scientists, and **27 research institutions** including NASA and Woods Hole Oceanographic Institution. Ben's attempt to swim roughly 5,000 miles across the Pacific doubled as a floating lab for what partners called "the most comprehensive study of our oceans to date." Produced **10 YouTube deep dives**, each translating one study, alongside live video, shorts, and a feature documentary. Shorty Award nominee.

Social Media Coordinator and Science Instructor | Catalina Island Marine Institute, Avalon, CA 2015 – 2017

- **Ran the editorial calendar, brand style, and daily publishing** across Instagram, Facebook, Twitter, and the blog, and led fellow instructors in producing short science videos.
- **Designed and taught** hands-on marine science lessons for student, family, and corporate groups.

Hollings Scholar and Sentinel Sites Program Fellow | NOAA, Honolulu, HI 2013 – 2015

- **Helped launch NOAA's Sentinel Site Initiative** with a virtual data and storytelling platform, using participatory GIS and ArcGIS Online to connect Indigenous and community stewards with sea level rise research.
- **Produced a short documentary** on Hawaiian wetland restoration; published "Community-Based Watershed Restoration in the Hawaiian Islands" (*Case Studies in the Environment*, UC Press, 2017).

EDUCATION AND AWARDS

Angel's Choice Award | Northern California Venture Conference (Solarpunk Studio) 2026

PILOT Innovation Challenge Winner | National Association of Broadcasters (Reinventing Media) 2022

M.A., Media Innovation (Experience and Information Design) | Northeastern University, Boston, MA 2021

CAMD Graduate Award for Creative and Research Projects | Northeastern University 2021

B.A., Biological Sciences; Minor, Marine Science and Policy | **High Honors** | Smith College, Northampton, MA 2015

YouTube Certified, Content Strategy | YouTube 2018

Coursework: Experience prototyping · Information design and visualization · Accessibility design · Media innovation

Communities: Machine Cinema (AI filmmakers) · Futurespaces · World Experience Organization · Epic Immersive · SXSW · Experiential Producers Room · Educators in VR · Video Consortium · Association for Women in Science